



▲ BONE HARPOON

Date c.28,000–13,000BCE

Origin Unknown

Length Unknown

Stone Age hunters did not just use stone for their weapons. From towards the end of the last Ice Age, 30,000–15,000 years ago, many weapons of bone survive, such as this harpoon, which might have been used for spearfishing.

Broad end for handgrip



Narrowed point

Rough cutting edge

◀ HAND AXE

Date 250,000–70,000BCE

Origin Unknown

Length 15cm (6in)

The first hand-held weapons, hand axes were essentially small rocks shaped to form a handgrip and blade. They were useful both as domestic tools and for attacking enemies.

Indentations where flint flakes were struck off



Fine edge for cutting

Sharp broad point

► SMALL CLOVIS POINT

Date c.10,000BCE

Origin North America

Length 10cm (4in)

Clovis points were made by alternately flaking off pieces from both sides of the core, creating fluted edges. They were a characteristic feature of the weapons used by settlers in North America from around 15,000 years ago. Clovis points were replaced by shorter and thinner Folsom points 8,000 years ago.



Fluted groove caused by striking off flakes

Cutting edge

Originally attached to shaft

► FLINT DAGGER HEAD

Date c.2000BCE

Origin Unknown

Length 15cm (6in)

By the Neolithic period, sophisticated blades such as this dagger head were being made by striking off flakes from a hard flint core, producing a sharp, flat blade.



Leather or sinew binding

Pointed flint blade



► LEVALLOIS FLAKE POINT

Date Post-300,000BCE

Origin Unknown

Length Unknown

The Levallois point was made by flaking off points from a central flint core to create the pattern of the desired shape, which was then struck off to create the final object. It had a characteristic scarring pattern on its surface.

